

Drake Thorne

Platform Engineer · Infrastructure Automation · AWS & Kubernetes

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Systems / Platform Engineer with 3+ years supporting high-availability production systems and 24/7 services. Experienced in operating Kubernetes workloads on AWS EKS, building infrastructure as code using Terraform and Ansible, and developing Python-based automation to reduce operational toil. Strong background in monitoring, incident response, and troubleshooting across cloud and network environments, ensuring reliable and scalable systems for end users.

CORE SKILLS

Languages: Python, Bash, PowerShell

Cloud & Infra: AWS (EKS, EC2, ECR, RDS, S3, IAM, VPC, ALB), Kubernetes, Helm, ArgoCD, Docker

IaC: Terraform, Ansible, AWX

Monitoring & Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, LogicMonitor

Networking: Cisco NXOS/IOS, Juniper, EVPN-VXLAN, cloud networking (VPC, Transit Gateway)

EXPERIENCE

Platform Engineer | Nine Entertainment

Aug 2024 – Present

- Built and operated production Kubernetes (EKS) services supporting critical internal platforms (NetBox, Docker Registry, Oxidized, Wiz, ArgoCD), owning deployment, uptime, monitoring, and incident response end-to-end
- Designed and deployed NetBox on AWS EKS (Helm, RDS/PostgreSQL, S3, ALB, Okta SAML), establishing a dynamic source of truth powering automation across 1500+ devices
- Monitored production systems using Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, and LogicMonitor, proactively identifying and resolving issues such as pod failures, OOM events, and resource constraints before user impact
- Engineered GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines enabling automated deployments, ECR image updates, and AWX-triggered jobs, reducing manual operational overhead and enabling self-service releases
- Wrote Python automation (custom Ansible plugins and tooling) to dynamically transform and normalise infrastructure data, eliminating manual processes and reducing operational complexity
- Automated AWS RDS (PostgreSQL) lifecycle management including snapshotting, restoration, and rebuild workflows, significantly improving recovery time and system resilience
- Designed and automated EVPN-VXLAN spine-leaf fabric across 40 switches, improving scalability, reliability, and fault isolation in production network environments
- Integrated automation across multiple external systems (Cloudflare, Infoblox, ServiceNow, FortiManager, Cisco ISE, LogicMonitor, NetBox), streamlining operational workflows and reducing response time during incidents
- Deployed ERSPAN-based monitoring and network visibility solutions, improving observability of traffic flows and assisting in rapid troubleshooting of network issues

Systems Administrator | Fin Design + Effects

Apr 2023 – Aug 2024

- Built and operated a full observability stack (Zabbix, Grafana, Graylog) across 500+ nodes, implementing alerting pipelines that significantly reduced incident detection and response times in a live production environment
- Managed Linux systems at scale using Ansible for configuration management, patching, and scheduling, improving consistency and reducing manual intervention
- Supported hybrid infrastructure across on-prem and cloud (VMware, GCP, Linux, Windows Server), maintaining uptime and stability in a fast-paced production environment
- Secured infrastructure through VPN (L2TP) with MFA (Duo) and hardened web services (Nginx/Apache), reducing risk exposure and improving overall system security posture

- Troubleshoot system, network, and application issues under time-sensitive conditions, ensuring minimal disruption to production workloads.

EDUCATION

Diploma of Information Technology, Computer Science | [Macquarie University](#)

Graduated 2022

WAM 81.875

Macquarie Association of Computing Students (MACS) · Academic Integrity Certification